HOBSONS BAY
CHESS CLUB
EST. 1974

Chess Sportsmanship and Etiquette

Don't argue with your opponent. If your opponent breaks a rule and does not correct the move when asked, or you disagree about the move, ask an arbiter to make a ruling on the situation.

Don't use outside materials. Use of any notes, printed material, recordings, an additional chessboard or a computer is prohibited. Violations may result in forfeiture of the game.

Leave all electronic equipment out the room. Phones, smart watches, tablets, e-books etc are not permitted as per FIDE Fair Play law. Violations may result in forfeiture of the game.

Adjusting pieces only during your turn. Do not adjust during opponent's turn. You must say "I adjust" clearly before adjusting your piece.

Don't give or ask for advice. You may not ask for advice on a move. Those attempting to offer advice should be asked to stop and the arbiter notified.

Don't be distracting. It can be distracting to talk to your opponent during a game. Other distracting behaviour includes tapping a pencil or clicking your chess pieces against the table, kicking the table, humming, and muttering, singing or talking to yourself. If your opponent is doing any of these things and does not stop when you ask him, get an arbiter.

Do not discuss your game in progress with anyone. Even after it's over, discussing or analysing your game is distracting to other players, so is normally not allowed near games in progress. Find a quiet place outside the playing room.

Be as polite, as clear, and as calm as possible when talking to the arbiter. Keep in mind that tournament arbiters, although specially trained, are human beings trying their best to enforce the rules and make discretionary rulings. Many of them serve on a volunteer basis to make the tournament a good experience for you. If you disagree with a ruling by an arbiter, you are permitted lodge official appeal to the appeal committee

Spectators are **observers only.** They have no special rights or privileges, and are not allowed to talk out loud, signal, or interfere in any way in games being played. Only the players can enforce rules during their games and get help from an arbiter when needed. It's best to have spectators at some distance from games, and **behind any players** with whom they are associated, to avoid any appearance of communication.

Asking to borrow your opponent's scoresheet, if you think you may have made an error, is permitted as long as the request is done while your clock is running.

If you wish to offer a draw, first make your move, then simply say "I offer a draw" and hit your clock. Do not extend your hand unless your opponent extends his/hers and accepts the draw. Do not pressure your opponent to accept a draw offer. If the offer is rejected, additional draw offers before the position has changed significantly may be reported to the arbiter as an annoyance.

If you're late, your opponent may begin the game and start the clock at the beginning of the round. Default time applies.

If you can't attend the match on that day, do provide Chief Arbiter with at least 24 hours advance notice just to be courteous to your opponent so he or she doesn't have to drive all the way to the club and has no one to play against. You can request 1x or 2x ½ point BYEs if you or your kid can't make it (except final 2 rounds), depending on number of rounds.